WORKBOOK 01 / 08 · MULTIMEDIA 12

Make a story the audience can read

Story beats, staging, scene construction and an animatic

THREE SCENES · ONE CAUSE-AND-EFFECT STORY

Discovery



Goal → decision

Crossing



Walk → jump → retrieve

Me_clever



Return cut → count → pride

Planning lengths: 144 f / 240 f / measured voice + ending hold

Three main Scenes form one cause-and-effect sequence. Lengths remain planning estimates until the voice is recorded.

Build: Build a readable three-Scene animatic before polishing any movement.

Keep: Caveman_01_story.fla + six-panel storyboard + silent animatic review

Shared story: A Caveman wants a third counting stone. A stream stands in his way. He studies it, commits to a jump, retrieves the stone and returns to count his collection with enormous pride.

Document: ActionScript 3.0 · 1280 × 720 · 24 fps · three main Scenes · Graphic symbols for scrubbable character actions

Two provisional 70-minute sessions. Use the HTML guide for read-aloud, switchable supports, recovery files and narrated explanation. This print version includes the essential support prompts.

Continue the same film

Create the project in Workbook 1. For every later workbook, open the selected previous production FLA and Save As a new numbered checkpoint, preserving all three Scenes and the complete Library. Keep repair/director copies separate; return to the chosen production version.

Understand before you animate

Staging directs attention. A story beat changes what the character knows, wants or does.

A Scene is a main-timeline section in Animate. A shot is one uninterrupted camera view. One Scene may contain several shots. This project begins with one shot per Scene so that story and file structure remain manageable.

Today’s checklist

1. Predict the result. 2. Build four stages. 3. Check in playback. 4. Refine, diagnose and direct. 5. Save and reopen.

Independent director condition

Move the third stone to a less obvious place. Change staging, gaze or timing so a viewer can still identify the goal without narration.

What you will defend

Where does the audience first understand the goal, and which visual choice makes it clear?

Support choices

Use the step summaries, glossary, numbered checklist, different-object examples, explanation frames and optional stretch. Open the companion HTML for browser read-aloud and the narrated six-slide explanation. Supports change access to the task; the success criteria remain the same.

Your planning notes

01 · Turn the premise into six changes

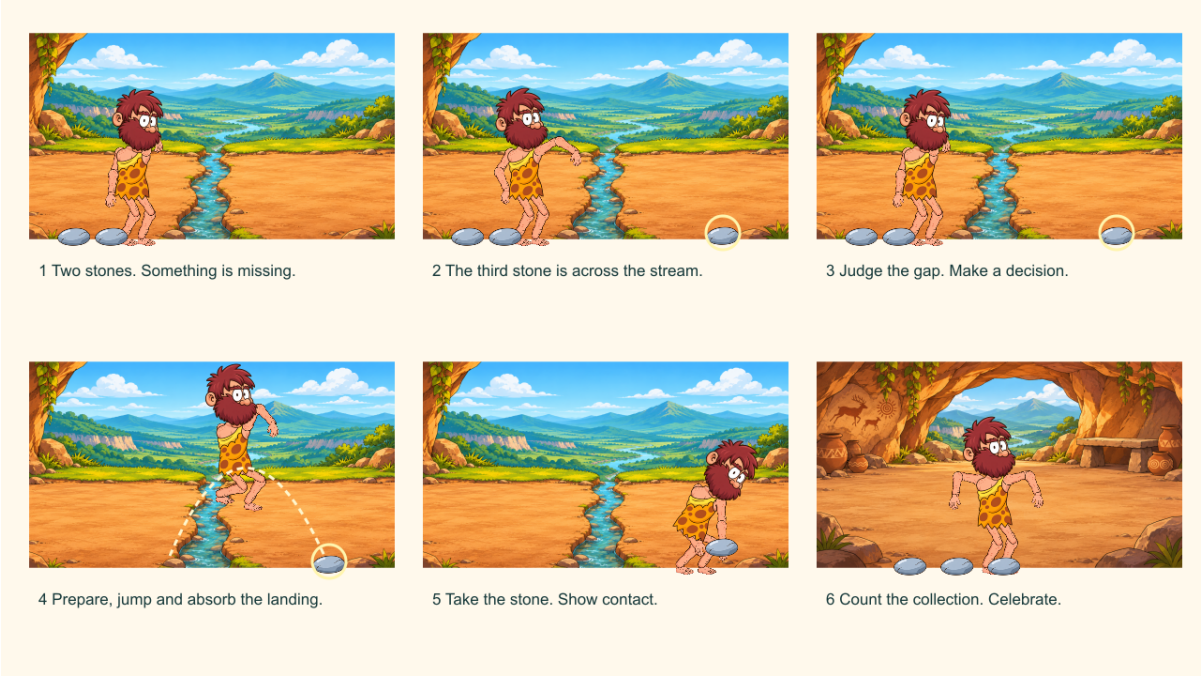
SELECT: Paper or the printable storyboard; no Animate selection yet.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Storyboard → goal → obstacle → decision → action → result.

1. Write six captions: notice two stones; spot the third; judge the stream; jump and land; retrieve the stone; count and celebrate.

2. Draw a thumbnail for each caption. Show the Caveman, the important prop and the direction of attention. Use arrows only for movement, not as a substitute for drawing the next pose.

3. Below each panel, write what changes. If two panels communicate the same information, combine them.



Illustrated story thumbnails: six changes develop one goal. These are authored planning drawings, not application screenshots.

WHY · Viewers need a chain of causes. A collection of effects does not explain why he jumps.

CHECK / SUMMARY · Cover the captions. A partner should be able to describe the want, obstacle and result from the drawings.

FIX · If the third stone looks like background decoration, isolate its silhouette, move it into the gaze line or give its reveal a short hold.

GLOSSARY · beat: A meaningful change in action, information or intention.; thumbnail: A small, quick composition drawing.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A squirrel sees a nut behind a fence, tests the gap and chooses a route. Each panel changes its decision.

STRETCH · Add a single visual joke after the result, without introducing a second story.

02 · Create the film document

SELECT: New document preset; then click an empty area of the Stage.

TOOLS / ROUTE: File → New → ActionScript 3.0; Properties → Doc.

1. Create an ActionScript 3.0 document. Set width 1280, height 720 and frame rate 24 fps. Use pixels.

2. Save as Caveman_01_story.fla in a project folder containing Assets, Audio, Exports and Evidence.

3. Write the document type and frame rate on your storyboard. Keep 24 fps through the series.

WHY · The document type affects sound and camera workflows. A stable frame rate makes timing calculations meaningful.

CHECK / SUMMARY · Doc properties show 1280 × 720 and 24 fps; the file has a saved location.

FIX · If you created HTML5 Canvas, create the correct document now and import the artwork again. Do not assume that changing publish settings changes document type.

GLOSSARY · Stage: The visible movie area.; frame rate: The number of timeline frames played each second.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · At 24 fps a 48-frame shot lasts two seconds; at 12 fps the same frames last four.

STRETCH · Explain why increasing fps does not add new designed poses.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

03 · Build the three main Scenes

SELECT: The main timeline, not the inside of a symbol.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Window → Other Panels → Scene; Insert → Scene; double-click Scene names.

1. Rename Scene 1 Discovery. Add Crossing and Me_clever. Order them Discovery → Crossing → Me_clever in the Scene panel.

2. In each Scene create Background, Props, Character and Notes layers. Lock Background after placement; keep Notes as a guide layer so notes do not appear in the movie.

3. Return to Discovery using the Scene panel. Check the breadcrumb above the Stage; it must show the Scene, not a nested character symbol.

WHY · Scenes divide the production into story sections. Named layers reduce wrong-object edits.

CHECK / SUMMARY · All three names are visible in the Scene panel and play in story order.

FIX · If artwork disappears after switching Scenes, it may belong to another Scene. Import or paste a deliberate copy into the intended Scene; do not duplicate random Library items.

GLOSSARY · Scene: A section of the main movie timeline.; layer: A separate timeline track for artwork or sound.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A three-shot weather report can use Intro, Forecast and Signoff Scenes with the same layer naming.

STRETCH · Plan when a shot change within a Scene would be clearer than adding another Scene.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

04 · Stage the goal and obstacle

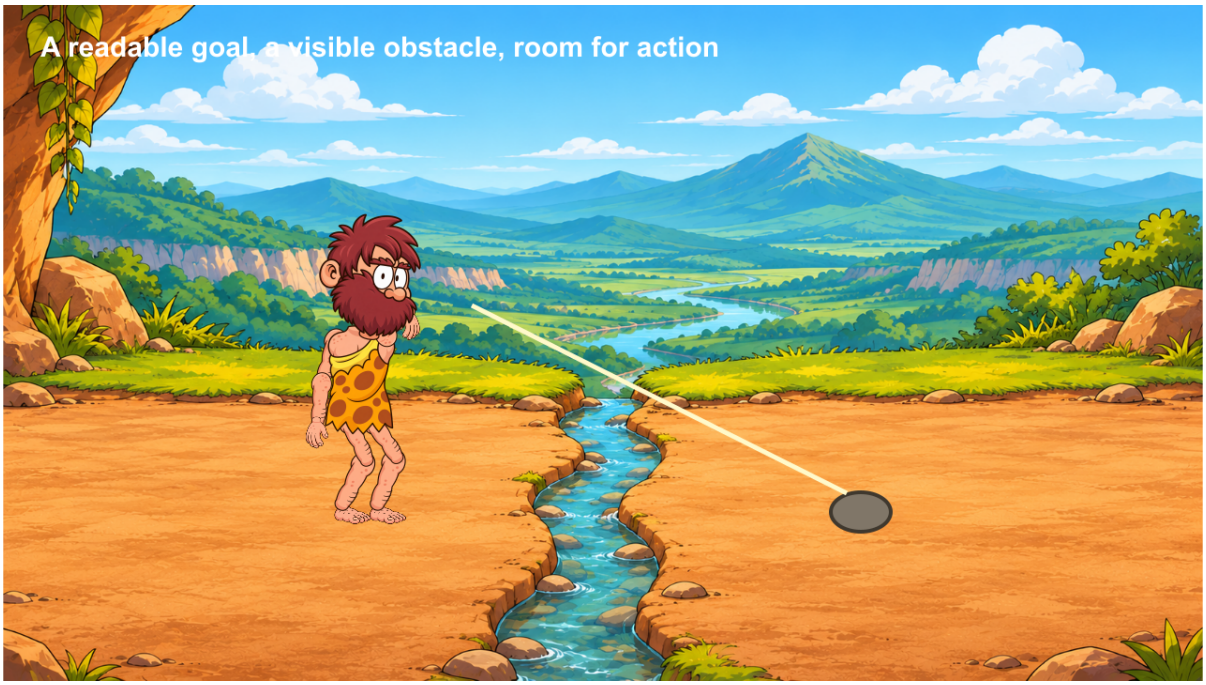
SELECT: Background layer frame 1; then the Props layer.

TOOLS / ROUTE: File → Import → Import to Stage; Properties → Position and Size; Modify → Convert to Symbol.

1. Place the stream background in Discovery and Crossing, and the cave background in Me_clever. This establishes the goal before the jump. Scale to fill the Stage without stretching one dimension independently.

2. Place two stones near the Caveman on the near bank in Discovery. Show the third stone clearly on the far bank in BOTH Discovery and Crossing. Keep its location consistent when the Scene changes. Convert each reusable prop to a Graphic symbol named Stone.

3. Keep a clear path of action from the near bank to the far bank. Use the Caveman reference as a temporary blocked pose. Do not animate the flattened reference as if its limbs were articulated.



Staging study: the stream is an obstacle and the isolated stone is a goal. Authored illustration using supplied Caveman art.

WHY · The viewer must read the destination and the danger before the jump begins.

CHECK / SUMMARY · At a small preview size, the Caveman, gap and goal are distinguishable. His feet can meet the ground plane.

FIX · Move the goal away from similarly coloured rocks. Enlarge it slightly for readability; do not add explanatory text as the first repair.

GLOSSARY · staging: Arranging elements to make an idea easy to read.; Graphic symbol: Reusable artwork with a timeline that can synchronize with its parent timeline.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A bright envelope on a dark desk is easier to notice than one hidden among identical papers.

STRETCH · Compare two camera distances and justify which better explains the jump.

05 · Block the film with held poses

SELECT: Character layer frames in each main Scene.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Timeline → Insert Frame / Insert Keyframe; Onion Skin for reference.

1. Use held drawings or reference poses to block Discovery at about 144 frames and Crossing at about 240 frames. These are planning lengths, not final performance timings.

2. For Me_clever, reserve a temporary 144 frames. Label it temporary until the real recording is placed in Workbook 6.

3. Use a keyframe only when the pictured pose or composition changes. Add ordinary frames to extend a hold. Test the entire movie, not only the current Scene.

WHY · A held-pose animatic exposes pacing and missing story information before detailed animation becomes expensive.

CHECK / SUMMARY · The silent film shows a decision before the jump and a result after it. Scene changes occur once, in order.

FIX · If a hold is too short to understand, add frames. If everything feels slow, shorten the uninformative hold rather than deleting the decision.

GLOSSARY · animatic: A timed sequence of story drawings used to test a film.; hold: A pose sustained for several frames.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A door creak can be blocked with closed, ajar and open drawings before animating the handle.

STRETCH · Show two versions of the decision hold and ask a viewer which implies greater caution.

06 · Use a deliberate cut back to the cave

SELECT: The end of Crossing and start of Me_clever.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Scene panel → Crossing / Me_clever; main timeline.

1. End Crossing with the stone visibly secured. Begin Me_clever with the third stone among the collection.

2. Keep the Caveman looking or moving in a compatible screen direction. Use the cave background to signal that time and location have changed.

3. Write one production note: “Return journey omitted; the cut advances time.” Do not accidentally imply that a single step teleports him across the stream.

WHY · Editing can omit routine travel while preserving cause and continuity.

CHECK / SUMMARY · A partner understands that he returned with the stone, rather than losing it or appearing in an unrelated place.

FIX · If the cut is confusing, add a brief departure pose or a settling pose at the cave. Add only the information the viewer needs.

GLOSSARY · ellipsis: A cut that omits a period of story time.; continuity: Consistency that helps an audience follow action across shots.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A baker puts dough in an oven; a later shot shows bread cooling. The cut omits baking time.

STRETCH · Design a matched-action cut without increasing the number of Scenes.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

07 · Repair an unreadable version

SELECT: A duplicate saved as Caveman_01_repair.fla.

TOOLS / ROUTE: File → Save As; timeline holds and prop placement.

1. Deliberately make the goal stone hard to see or remove the decision hold in the duplicate. Play it to a partner without explaining.

2. Ask what the Caveman wants and why he jumps. Record the exact misunderstanding.

3. Repair one variable, replay and retain before/after frames. Explain why the repair addresses that misunderstanding.

WHY · Diagnosis connects visual choices to audience understanding.

CHECK / SUMMARY · Your evidence identifies a visible problem, one repair and a viewer response after the repair.

FIX · If your explanation says only “better,” name the missing information and the visual cue that now supplies it.

GLOSSARY · revision: A purposeful change based on a problem or feedback.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · Moving a button away from a busy pattern repairs visibility more directly than changing every page colour.

STRETCH · Test the film with the sound off and the screen reduced to a thumbnail.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

08 · Direct your first independent change

SELECT: Your own story file; preserve the guided version.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Save As → Caveman_01_director.fla.

1. Apply the changed-condition brief above. Keep the same goal, obstacle, three Scenes and character identity.

2. Re-stage the discovery; do not copy the worked composition unchanged. Test the silent animatic with a new viewer.

3. Save, close and reopen. Submit the storyboard, FLA and one before/after explanation using your teacher's named collection route. This local guide does not submit school work.

WHY · The independent variation shows whether you can transfer staging decisions.

CHECK / SUMMARY · The goal remains readable under your new condition and the reopened file retains all three Scenes.

FIX · If you changed the story to avoid the problem, restore the constraint and solve it through composition or timing.

GLOSSARY · transfer: Using a learned idea in a changed situation.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · Independent task: use the success criteria; no worked director solution is supplied.

STRETCH · Create a second ending only after the core three-Scene story reads clearly.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

Keep a small, useful evidence record

At frame ___, I chose ___ so the viewer could ___.
The problem was caused by ___. I changed ___ and checked ___.
Under the changed condition, I revised ___ because ___.

One repair

One independent decision and its trade-off

Delivery check

The selected file reopens. The result plays as intended. Joints/contact and audio were checked where relevant. The changed condition is solved. Required production files and a brief defence are retained.

Method references and attribution

A1 · Adobe Animate: symbols and instances · Adobe reference

A2 · Adobe Animate: timeline layers · Adobe reference

A3 · Adobe Animate: shape tweening · Adobe reference

A4 · Adobe Animate: parenting view · Adobe reference

A5 · Adobe Animate: sound · Adobe reference

A6 · Adobe Animate: camera · Adobe reference

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